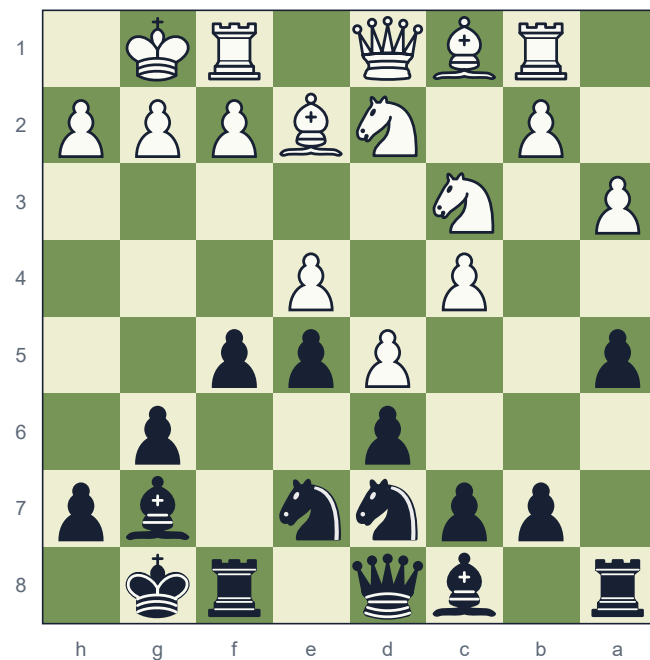


Other ninth moves in the closed Classical

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Keep ...Nd7 and ...f5 as the main framework, but adjust to Nd2, Bd2, a4 and b3. The defender of e4 and the speed of c5 determine the details.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The locked d5/e4 versus d6/e5 center remains, but White's pieces may be prepared for defense or immediate queenside action.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Look for the role of the d2 square.
2. Do not let a maneuver lose e5.
3. Compare the speed of White's plan with 9.Ne1.

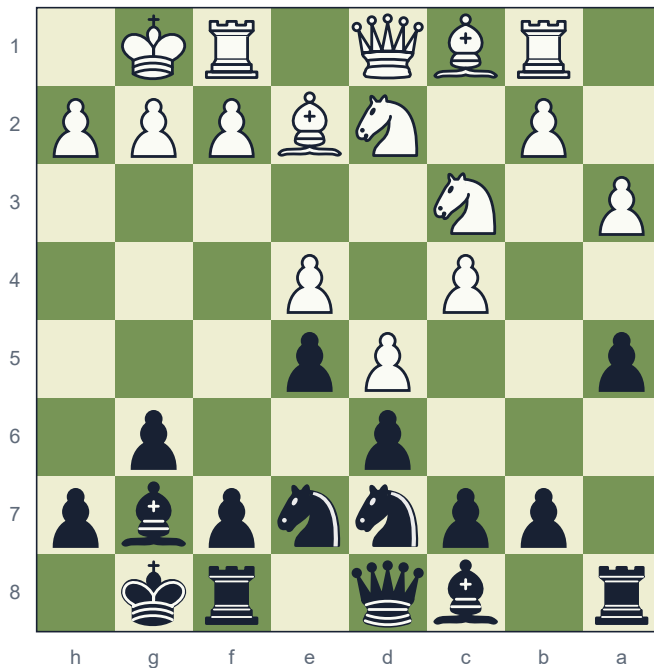
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 9.Nd2: the modern system

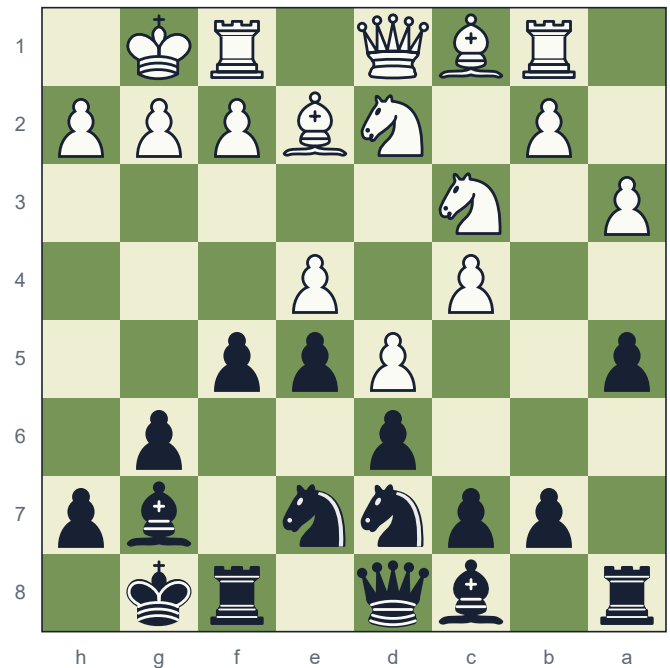
STUDY LINE 05-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Nd2 a5 10. a3 Nd7 11. Rb1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 11... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a5 makes b4 harder. The f6 knight vacates for ...f5 only after White has spent time arranging the queenside.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Nf6 or ...Nc5 according to the exchanges. White may use b4 anyway, or jump to c4 to target d6.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Nd2 may support c4 or allow f3 later. Avoid weakening b6 and d6 without compensation.

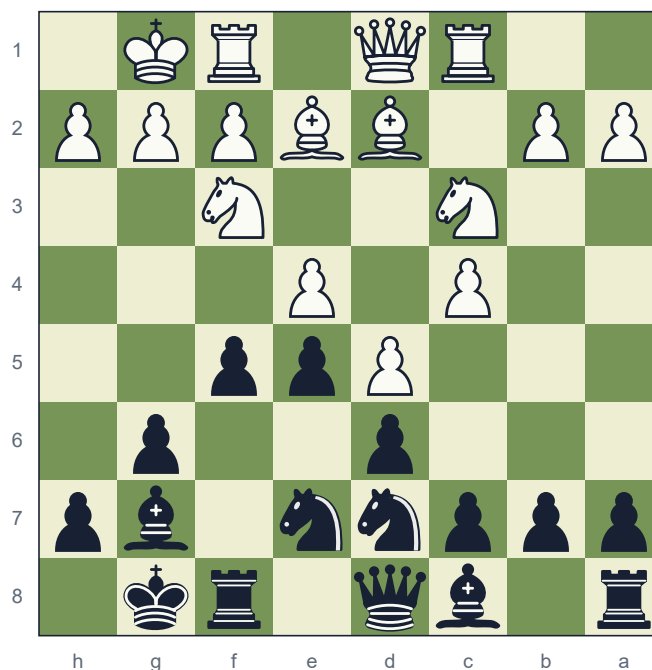
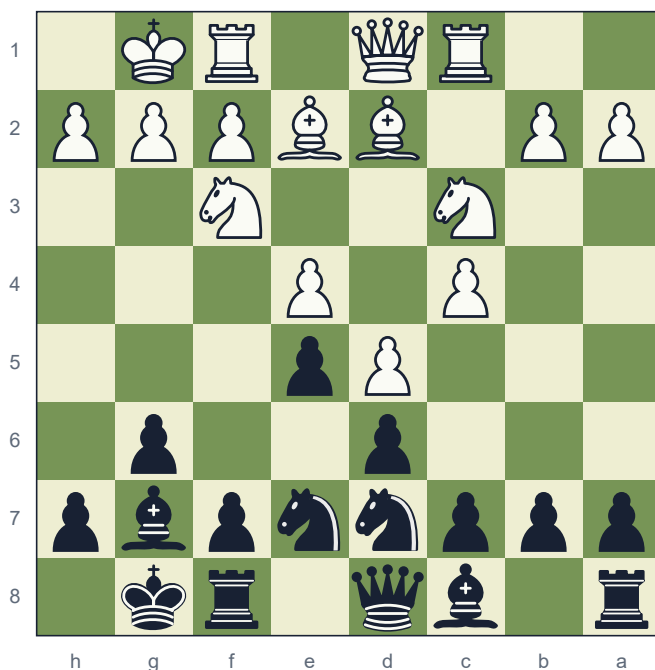
REMEMBER Restrain one break while preparing your own.

02 9.Bd2: flexible development

STUDY LINE 05-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Bd2 Nd7 10. Rc1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

Bd2 connects White's development and Rc1 points at the queenside. Black clears f6 and contests e4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Check whether ...f4 gains a useful tempo. If the bishop stays on d2, that tempo is absent and maintaining tension can matter.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The familiar ...f4 attack on Be3 does not exist when the bishop is on d2.

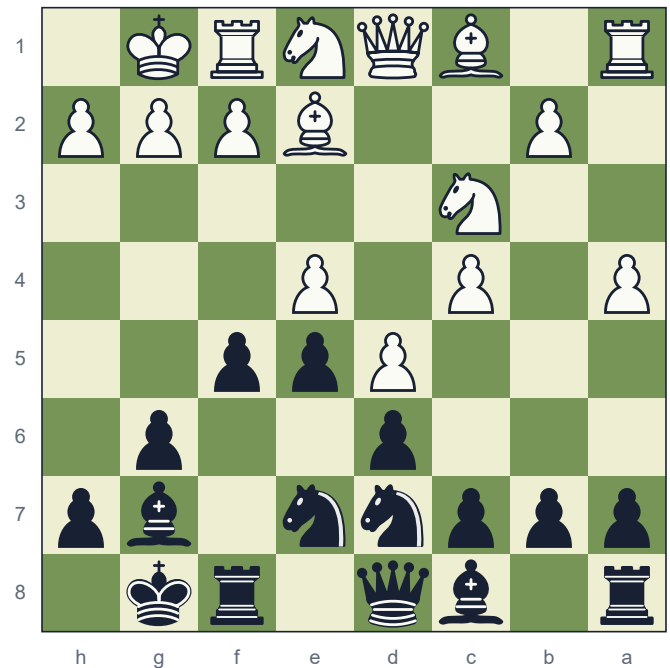
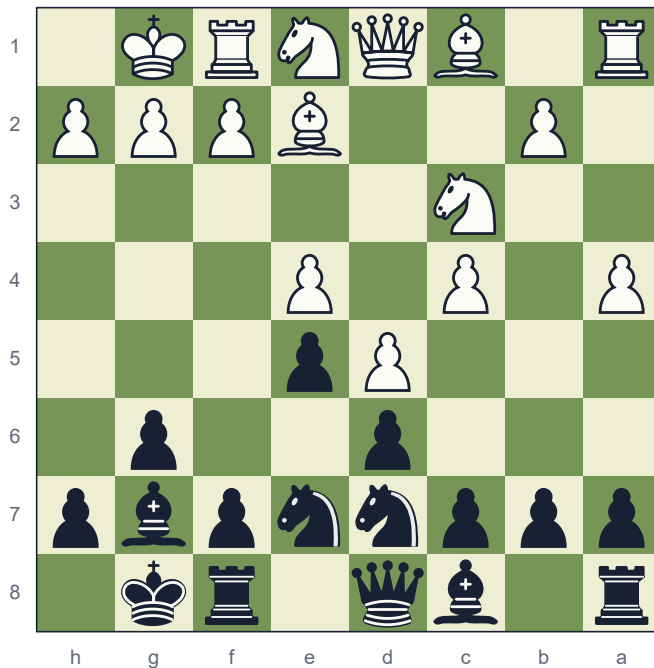
REMEMBER A pawn advance is better when it attacks something.

03 9.a4: White gains space

STUDY LINE 05-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. a4 Nd7 10. Ne1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

a4 restrains ...b5 but spends a move away from e4. Black follows the central break while remaining alert to a5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

After the center stabilizes, coordinate the kingside pieces. White has less direct b4 expansion but more a-file space.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not answer every flank pawn with a flank pawn; use the time to complete a meaningful plan.

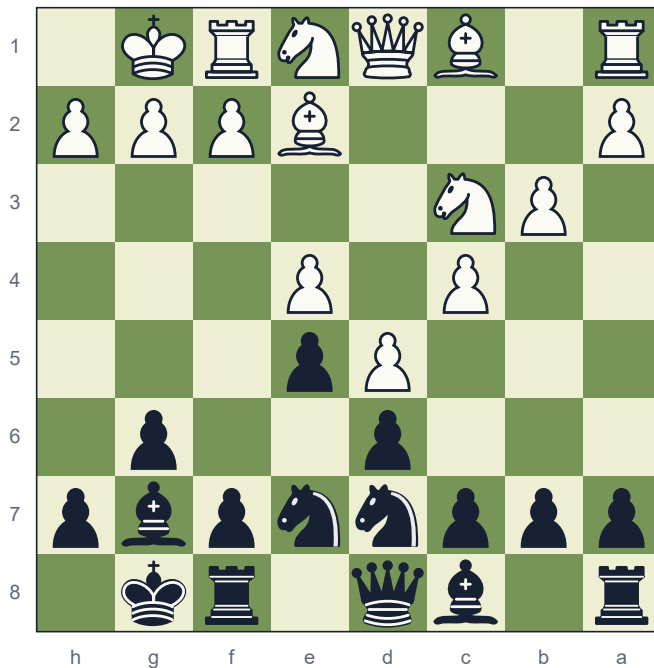
REMEMBER Space costs time; use the time purposefully.

04 9.b3: a queenside fianchetto

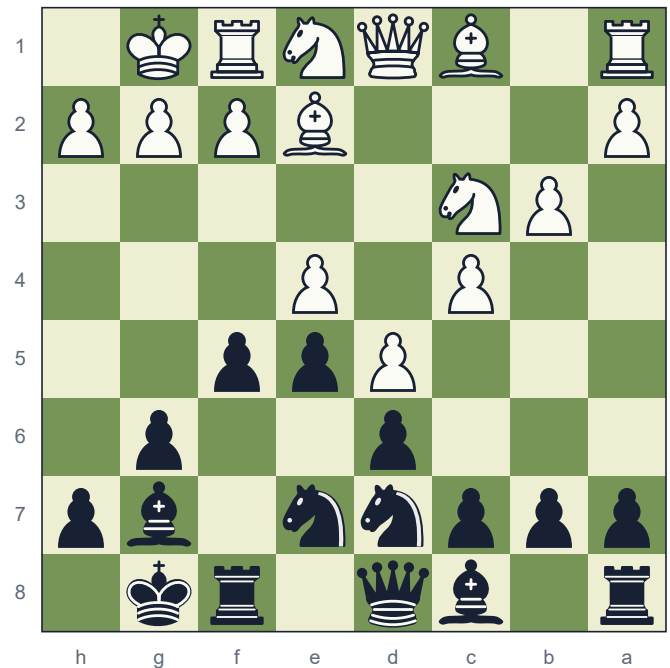
STUDY LINE 05-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b3 Nd7 10. Ne1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

b3 prepares Bb2 and supports c4. Black develops the same pawn break against the strong center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

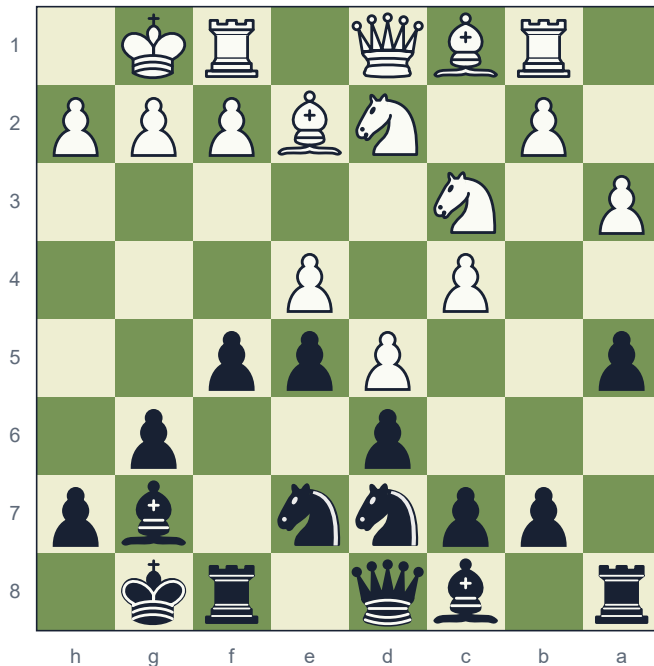
Assess the b2 bishop's diagonal when the center opens. Pressure on e4 may change after White advances c5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The long diagonal can become active suddenly after pawn exchanges. Count discovered attacks on g7.

REMEMBER A blocked bishop is not permanently inactive.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The locked d5/e4 versus d6/e5 center remains, but White's pieces may be prepared for defense or immediate queenside action.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Prepare ...Nf6 or ...Nc5 according to the exchanges. White may use b4 anyway, or jump to c4 to target d6.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.